

Council Briefing Draft — 2026-12-05

Matt's personal working notes for the Dec 8 Council meeting

2026-12-05 Council Briefing Draft

Author	Matt Coleman
For	December 8 Church Council meeting - Holiday Celebration status
Status	Draft in progress. Do not share.
Last touched	2026-12-05 6:12 AM (kitchen table, second cup of coffee)

Questions I need answered before I stand up Tuesday

1. Is the \$4,850 landed number Pastor David's number or is it going to collide with Frank's \$5,600 tracker at the microphone?
2. If the council authorizes \$1,760 to close the reconciled gap where does it come from - reserves, an emergency second offering, or scaling the celebration down?
3. Do I ask for the wellness \$180 supplement separately or roll it into the total?
4. Do I say publicly that we are sizing for 215 people or do I ask the council to authorize the overflow tray and additional chair rental as a discretionary decision?
5. Who signs Elena's deposit check now that we are past December 1 and she is holding the spot on trust?

Draft opening (needs review)

"Pastor David, council members. Before I walk you through the picture I want to be honest about one thing. What the Events Committee has been carrying as our working number and what the accounts show are two different numbers, and I want you to see both so we make Saturday's decisions against the real one, not the polished one."

Money - what to say

- Landed and reconciled across Stripe PayPal Square and the cash log Rosa keeps: \$4,850
- Committee tracker (Frank's number): \$5,600
- Gap: \$750 sitting in six pledges (Whitfield, Padilla, Lam, Orozco, Morrison, Figueroa) marked received in Notion but not deposited anywhere
- Vendor obligations reconciled with the escalated confirmations plus the wellness \$180 delta plus the \$400 QuickBooks line-item understatement: \$6,610 (up from the committee's \$5,375 stated figure by \$1,235)
- Actual position: \$1,760 short before Saturday
- Recommendation for the council: acknowledge the gap, decide the plug

Money - what to hold

- Do not use Frank's name from the microphone. Frame the tracker inflation as an accounting-methodology gap, not a personal error.
- Do not commit to the Elena overflow tray until the council decides on scale.
- Do not confirm Casa Flores \$475 line as approved until the council sees the \$25 escalation.

Volunteers - the picture

- 38 confirmed
- 8 maybe
- 8 no response
- 54 total roster

Coverage by role (confirmed count):

- Food service: 9 confirmed
- Children's area: 3 confirmed
- Parking: 2 confirmed
- Cleanup: 5 confirmed

The children's area, parking, and cleanup lines are the ones that keep me up. If I stand up at service Sunday and ask for four more names I might get them. If not the council needs to know we are short in those roles and Rosa and I will absorb the gap.

Vendors - the picture

- Elena's Kitchen: \$2,800 original, \$3,400 confirmed. Deposit \$1,700 was due December 1. She is holding my spot on trust. This is a \$600 escalation.
- Casa Flores: \$450 original, \$475 confirmed. Yolanda flagged the \$25 escalation on the altar arrangement.
- Los Hermanos Trio: \$600 flat. No change.
- El Paso Party Rentals: \$350 original, \$380 confirmed. \$30 delivery-and-setup fee that was not in the original.
- Audio Express EP: \$175. No change.

Total vendor obligation confirmed: \$5,030 across the five contracted vendors before beverages, paper goods, printing, and cleanup supplies.

Wellness - the picture

- Committee allocation: \$400
- Projected actual: \$580
- Delta: \$180 over
- Root cause: screening supplies (\$185 vs \$100 budgeted) and honorariums (\$150 vs \$100 budgeted) both came in higher than the September estimate. Herbal materials and printed cards came in under.
- Ask: council authorization for the \$180 supplement OR I absorb it out of pocket. I am willing to absorb it if the council would rather not add another line.

Capacity - the picture

- Seating capacity confirmed with El Paso Party Rentals: 175 chairs
- Best current estimate of headcount from Typeform + Eventbrite + paper sign-ups: 215
- Gap: 40 people beyond 175
- Options:

1. Approve overflow catering tray from Elena at her per-plate quote and add ~40 chairs from EPR (call to check availability required) 2. Communicate a "first come first seated" rotation and standing-room welcome for latecomers 3. Hold the line at 175 and close registration Sunday

Decisions I need FROM the council (not from me alone)

- Close the \$1,760 gap: which lever
- Approve or decline the wellness \$180 supplement
- Approve or decline the Elena overflow tray and chair augmentation
- Communication plan for the Whitfield Padilla Lam Orozco Morrison Figueroa households before Saturday
- Who covers the food-service, children's-area, parking, and cleanup gaps

What I refuse to guess at

- I will not put a number in the report I cannot back up against Stripe PayPal Square a deposit slip or a signed confirmation email.
- I will not name a donor as delinquent from the microphone. Those conversations happen privately after the meeting.
- I will not confirm 215 attendance publicly until I have run one more pass through Typeform for duplicates against Eventbrite.

Personal

Pray at 6am tomorrow. Walk 6:30. Coffee with Pastor David at 7:30 Monday. Sit with Rosa Monday afternoon and walk her through the roster gaps. Sunday morning at service ask for four more names for the coverage lines that are short. Do not confirm anything in front of the assistant that you would not confirm in front of Rosa. Draft and hold everything until Tuesday.

Signed 2026-12-05